

# Fables & Morals

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## Grade 3 Reading Worksheet

### Hilda the Hoarding Squirrel

High in an oak tree lived Hilda the squirrel. All autumn, she gathered acorns and hid them in her hollow. When Pip the chipmunk asked for just one acorn, Hilda shook her head. "Mine!" she said. Winter came with a great storm. The wind cracked Hilda's branch, and her hollow full of acorns tumbled to the ground and washed away. Hungry and cold, Hilda knocked on Pip's door. Pip had saved only a few nuts, but he shared them with her. Hilda's cheeks burned with shame. "Thank you," she whispered. From that day on, Hilda always shared her food.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. Sharing with others brings help when you need it.
  - b. Acorns taste best in autumn.
  - c. Storms break tree branches.
2. What happened to Hilda's acorns?
  - a. She ate them all
  - b. Pip stole them
  - c. They washed away in a storm
3. How did Hilda feel when Pip shared his nuts with her?

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### Robbie Rabbit Races the Wind

Robbie Rabbit was the fastest runner in the meadow. "No one can beat me!" he bragged every day. One morning, he shouted at the sky, "Even the wind cannot beat me!" The wind heard him and laughed, "Let us race to the old oak tree." Robbie dashed off, but the wind rushed past him in a swirl of leaves. Robbie ran and ran until his legs ached, but the wind was already waiting at the tree. Robbie hung his head. He never bragged again.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. Rabbits run fast.
  - b. Trees are tall.
  - c. Do not brag about things you cannot do.
2. Who did Robbie race?
  - a. The wind
  - b. A turtle
  - c. A deer
3. How did Robbie feel after the race?

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### The Two Frogs and the Lily Pad

Two frogs, Flip and Flop, lived in the same pond. One sunny day, they both spotted the biggest, greenest lily pad. "It is mine!" croaked Flip. "No, it is mine!" croaked Flop. They pushed and splashed and argued all afternoon. At last, with one big shove, the lily pad tore in half and sank. Both frogs stared at the muddy water. A wise old fish swam by and said, "If you had shared it, you would both be sitting in the sun."

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. It is better to share than to fight.
  - b. Lily pads are green.
  - c. Fish are wise.
2. What happened to the lily pad?
  - a. It floated away
  - b. A fish ate it
  - c. It tore in half and sank
3. What did the old fish say to the frogs?

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### Bruno Bear Counts Stars

Bruno Bear loved the night sky. Every evening, he sat outside his cave and counted the twinkling stars. "One hundred! Two hundred!" he whispered. But while Bruno counted stars, autumn slipped away. The other bears caught fat salmon from the river and grew round for winter. Bruno caught nothing. When the snow came, Bruno's tummy rumbled with hunger. He had no fat to keep him warm. "I should have fished first and counted stars later," he sighed.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
    - a. Stars are beautiful.
    - b. Do your work before you play.
    - c. Bears sleep in winter.
  2. What did the other bears do in autumn?
    - a. Built caves
    - b. Caught salmon
    - c. Counted stars
  3. Why was Bruno hungry when winter came?
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### Milo Mouse and the Thorn

Milo Mouse was hurrying home when he heard a sad whimper. Behind a bush sat Hazel the hedgehog with a sharp thorn stuck in her paw. "Please help me," she cried. Milo was small, but he was brave. He pulled and pulled until the thorn came out. Hazel smiled through her tears. "Thank you, little friend." Weeks later, a hungry cat chased Milo. He had nowhere to hide, until Hazel curled into a spiky ball and rolled between Milo and the cat. The cat ran away!

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. Cats are scary.
  - b. Thorns are sharp.
  - c. Kindness is never wasted.
2. What was wrong with Hazel?
  - a. She was lost
  - b. A thorn in her paw
  - c. She was hungry
3. How did Hazel save Milo from the cat?

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### Polly the Copycat Parrot

Polly the parrot could copy every sound she heard. She copied the crow's caw and the dog's bark. One day, she heard the farmer shout angry words at his broken cart. Polly repeated those rude words all day long. The other animals covered their ears. The wise owl said, "Polly, not every word should be repeated." Polly felt sorry. From then on, she copied only kind words, like "good morning" and "thank you." Soon everyone loved to hear Polly talk.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. Carts break often.
  - b. Think before you speak.
  - c. Parrots have colorful feathers.
2. What did Polly copy from the farmer?
  - a. A happy song
  - b. His laugh
  - c. Angry, rude words
3. What kind words did Polly copy later?

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### Tessa Turtle's Painted Shell

Tessa Turtle thought her plain brown shell was dull. When she saw Ruby the ladybug's bright red spots, she wished she could shine too. Tessa painted her shell with red and yellow stripes. "Now I am beautiful!" she said. But when the rain came, the paint ran into her eyes and made them sting. Tessa scrubbed the paint away and looked at her smooth brown shell. "This shell has kept me safe all my life," she said. "It is perfect just as it is."

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. Be happy with who you are.
  - b. Paint washes off in rain.
  - c. Ladybugs are red.
2. Why did Tessa paint her shell?
  - a. For a party
  - b. To hide from foxes
  - c. She thought it was dull
3. What happened when it rained?

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### Wally Wasp Wants Honey

Wally Wasp loved honey, but he did not like to work. Every day, he watched the bees buzz from flower to flower, making sweet honey. "Give me some honey!" Wally demanded. The queen bee said, "If you want honey, you must help make it." Wally buzzed away angrily. Days passed, and Wally grew thin and hungry. At last, he returned to the hive. "Teach me to work," he begged. The bees taught him to gather nectar. That winter, Wally tasted honey he had helped make. It was the sweetest honey of all.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. Winter is cold.
  - b. Wasps are lazy.
  - c. You must work for what you want.
  
2. What did the queen bee tell Wally?
  - a. To find a new home
  - b. He must help make honey
  - c. To leave the hive
  
3. Why was the honey the sweetest of all?

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### Oliver Owl and the Fireflies

Oliver Owl was proud of his big, bright eyes. "I can see in the dark better than anyone!" he hooted. One summer night, tiny fireflies began to glow around the pond. Their little lights danced like stars. The other animals gasped with joy. Oliver felt jealous. "My eyes are brighter!" he said. The eldest firefly glowed softly. "Your eyes are wonderful, Oliver. And our lights are wonderful too. The night is big enough for every kind of light." Oliver smiled. He had learned something new.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. Summer nights are warm.
  - b. Owls sleep in daytime.
  - c. Everyone has their own special gift.
2. What did the fireflies do?
  - a. Slept in the grass
  - b. Glowed like tiny stars
  - c. Sang songs
3. What did the eldest firefly say?

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### Daisy Duckling's Loud Quack

Daisy Duckling loved her loud quack. She quacked at breakfast. She quacked at lunch. She quacked at dinner. One afternoon, the ducklings played hide-and-seek in the tall grass. Daisy hid behind the reeds and waited. When Mama Duck came looking, Daisy could not stay quiet. "QUACK! QUACK!" she shouted. Mama found her at once. "Daisy," laughed Mama, "there is a time to quack and a time to be still." Daisy nodded. In the next game, she stayed as quiet as a mouse, and won!

1. What is the moral of this fable?
  - a. Hide-and-seek is fun.
  - b. There is a time to speak and a time to be quiet.
  - c. Ducks like water.
2. How did Mama Duck find Daisy?
  - a. Daisy quacked loudly
  - b. She saw her tail
  - c. A frog told her
3. What happened in the next game?

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